

Wednesday, 1 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

25° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

23° 16°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

20° 16°

GLASGOW

Light rain

18° 14°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **A new independent inquiry has found "unacceptable racism and discrimination" is affecting patient safety in UK maternity care.**

The damning report concludes that failings in maternity services are so severe they 'shame our society'. The government has promised to act on the findings.

HEALTH · UK

- 2 **The government says it has no legal powers to deport a grooming gang ringleader from the UK, due to a 55-year-old law.**

Shabir Ahmed, 55, cannot be removed from the country despite his conviction. This revelation is likely to spark debate about current legislation.

JUSTICE · UK

- 3 **Brace yourselves for another potential UK heatwave later this week, as parts of Europe continue to swelter in record temperatures.**

Forecasters are predicting higher temperatures could develop across the country. It follows a period of intense heat and thunderstorms across the UK last week.

WEATHER · UK

- 4 **Under new proposals, refugees could be told to repay around £10,000 for asylum support they've received in the UK.**

The Home Office would be given powers to recover costs from adults who have received assistance under these new laws. It's part of a new asylum bill.

IMMIGRATION · UK

- 5 **Andy Burnham, a contender for Labour leadership, plans to work some days in Manchester if he becomes Prime Minister.**

The former Greater Manchester mayor intends to establish a new No 10 unit in the city. This would be a significant shift from traditional Downing Street operations.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Imagine being on a school trip to London and bumping into Dwayne 'The Rock' Johnson!**
That's exactly what happened to about 50 children from Sudbury. They got a huge surprise meeting the Hollywood star during their visit.
ON AIR – What's the most unexpected celebrity encounter you've ever had?
CELEBRITY · NOW
- 2 Metallica have shown their generous side, donating £20,000 to a city food bank with 'empty shelves' after their sell-out gig.**
The band's huge donation is enough for 9,000 meals. It came after they performed their record-breaking M72 World Tour.
ON AIR – Isn't it great when big stars give back to the communities where they perform?
MUSIC · NOW
- 3 Millie Bobby Brown has been chatting about having her 'hands and heart' all over the new Enola Holmes detective adventure series.**
She and co-star Louis Partridge shared insights into the show, talking about 'belly laughs' and 'sibling vibes' on set. Fans are eagerly awaiting the latest instalment.
ON AIR – Are you a fan of the Enola Holmes series, and what do you love about it?
TV & FILM · COMING UP
- 4 Linkin Park is set to make history as the first female-fronted band to headline Download Festival.**
It's a huge moment for the rock world, though some are calling it 'bittersweet' that it's taken this long. The festival is a major event in the UK music calendar.
ON AIR – Do you think it's surprising that it's taken until now for a female-fronted band to headline Download?
MUSIC · COMING UP
- 5 A union is urging GTA 6 maker Rockstar to address working conditions ahead of the highly anticipated game's release.**
They're calling for better working conditions and pay transparency for the developers. Grand Theft Auto 6 is one of the most eagerly awaited video games in years.
ON AIR – Are you looking forward to GTA 6, and do you think game developers deserve better working conditions?
GAMING · COMING UP

On the schedule

1

Four-time winners Germany have been knocked out of the 2026 World Cup, losing to Paraguay 4-3 on penalties.

The match finished 1-1 after extra time, leading to a dramatic shootout. Germany's early exit is a huge shock in the tournament.

ON AIR – What a shocker! Did you predict Germany going out so early in the World Cup?

FOOTBALL · UK

2

Wimbledon has seen a mixed bag for British players on day one, with three wins but 13 early exits.

Katie Swan, Jacob Fearnley, and Arthur Fery ensured home representation in the second round. However, many others fell to first-round defeats.

ON AIR – Are you optimistic for the British players still in Wimbledon, or is it going to be a tough tournament?

TENNIS · UK

3

Former England captain Wayne Rooney has weighed in on the World Cup, saying he'd start Kobbie Mainoo over Elliot Anderson.

Rooney believes the Manchester United midfielder should play in Wednesday's last-32 tie against DR Congo. It's a big call from the England legend.

ON AIR – Do you agree with Rooney? Should Mainoo start for England against DR Congo?

FOOTBALL · UK

4

Novak Djokovic has begun his bid for a record 25th Grand Slam title with a hard-fought win at Wimbledon.

He overcame China's Wu Yibing in four gritty sets, even managing to get a wedding invitation during the match. Djokovic is always one to watch at SW19.

ON AIR – Can anyone stop Djokovic from claiming another Wimbledon title this year?

TENNIS · UK

5

The US takeover of Premiership Rugby side Exeter Chiefs has been completed, with Black Knight now in charge.

The owners of Premier League club Bournemouth have taken the reins at Exeter. This marks a significant moment for the club and English rugby.

ON AIR – Do you think more US investment in UK sports is a good thing for the game?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 Scientists have found that 'listening to birdsong' can significantly reduce stress and improve mood.**
A recent study suggests that even short bursts of natural bird sounds can have a calming effect, helping to lower anxiety levels and boost feelings of wellbeing.
- 2 The humble 'board game' is making a grand comeback as families seek screen-free entertainment.**
Sales of classic and modern board games are soaring, with many rediscovering the joy of face-to-face interaction and friendly competition away from digital devices.
- 3 Experts are encouraging us to rediscover the simple pleasure of 'writing a postcard' whilst on holiday.**
It's a lovely way to share your travels with loved ones and offers a personal touch that a quick text or email often can't match.
- 4 A new trend sees people embracing 'foraging for wild ingredients' to add unique flavours to their cooking.**
From wild garlic to elderflowers, keen cooks are safely identifying and gathering nature's bounty to create delicious, seasonal dishes.
- 5 Researchers highlight the benefits of 'walking barefoot on grass' for improving posture and reducing foot pain.**
It's thought that feeling the natural texture beneath your feet can strengthen foot muscles and improve overall balance, connecting us more with nature.
- 6 The art of 'collecting vinyl records' is seeing a vibrant resurgence among music enthusiasts of all ages.**
Many are enjoying the tactile experience of handling records and the warm, rich sound quality that vinyl offers, making music listening a more immersive event.
- 7 More people are finding creative joy in 'mending and repairing clothes' rather than simply replacing them.**
It's a sustainable approach that not only saves money but also allows for personal expression, turning everyday wear into unique, well-loved items.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'naming' what, even though we know they don't really have feelings?

ANSWER: THEIR CAR.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'lucky item' of clothing that they absolutely have to wear on important occasions. What is it?

ANSWER: A SPECIFIC PAIR OF SOCKS.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you try a 'new hot drink' that isn't tea or coffee, and it becomes your new favourite?**

Maybe it's a spiced chai, a herbal infusion, or something completely different! What unexpected hot drink has won you over recently?

- **We all have those 'little bits of kit' around the house that we genuinely couldn't do without, don't we?**

It could be a particular kitchen gadget, a handy tool, or even a specific cleaning product. What's the one household item you absolutely couldn't live without?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Did you know that a group of pugs is actually called a 'grumble'?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Apparently, a flock of flamingos is known as a 'flamboyance', owing to their bright colours.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- Butterflies taste with their feet, allowing them to detect host plants for their eggs.
- The world's oldest known living tree is a bristlecone pine named 'Methuselah', estimated to be over 4,800 years old.
- A 'jiffy' is an actual unit of time, specifically one-hundredth of a second in computing.
- The longest recorded flight of a chicken is 13 seconds, demonstrating their surprising aerial ability.
- Pineapples are actually berries, growing from multiple flowers that fuse together.
- The smell of freshly cut grass is actually a plant distress signal, released to warn other plants.
- Mars is known as the 'Red Planet' due to the iron oxide prevalent on its surface, which is essentially rust.
- The average cloud weighs around 550 tons, roughly the same as 100 elephants.

On this day

Day 182 of the year, 183 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aaron (Catholic Church and Syriac Christianity); Christian feast day: Blessed Antonio Rosmini-Serbatì; Christian feast day: Junípero Serra; Christian feast day: Julius and Aaron. Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1948 — John Ford, English-American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1962 — Andre Braugher, American actor (died 2023)
- 1956 — Alan Ruck, American actor
- 1943 — Jeff Wayne, American composer, musician and lyricist
- 1957 — Lisa Blount, American actress and producer (died 2010)
- 1952 — Dan Aykroyd, Canadian actor, producer and screenwriter
- 1951 — Fred Schneider, American singer-songwriter and keyboard player
- 2001 — Chosen Jacobs, American actor and singer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — The Northern Territory in Australia is granted self-government.
- 1983 — The Ministry of State Security is established as China's principal intelligence agency
- 1980 — "O Canada" officially becomes the national anthem of Canada.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2007 — Smoking in England is banned in all public indoor spaces.
- 1990 — German reunification: East Germany accepts the Deutsche Mark as its currency, thus uniting the economies of East and West Germany.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 2020 — The United States–Mexico–Canada Agreement replaces NAFTA.
- 1983 — The Ministry of State Security is established as China's principal intelligence agency
- 2006 — The first operation of Qinghai–Tibet Railway is conducted in China.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 183 of the year, 182 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Aberoh and Atom (Coptic Church); Christian feast day: Bernardino Realino; Christian feast day: Blessed Eugénie Joubert; Christian feast day: Feast of the Visitation (Anglicanism; Levoča at Mariánska hora). Star sign Cancer, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Paul Williams, American singer and choreographer (died 1973)
- 1970 — Steve Morrow, Northern Irish footballer and manager
- 1975 — Elizabeth Reaser, American actress
- 1985 — Ashley Tisdale, American actress, singer, and producer
- 1972 — Darren Shan, Irish author
- 1993 — Saweetie, American rapper
- 1920 — John Kneubuhl, Samoan-American historian, screenwriter, and playwright (died 1992)
- 1956 — Jerry Hall, American model and actress

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1881 — Charles J. Guiteau shoots and fatally wounds U.S. President James A. Garfield (who will die of complications from his wounds on September 19).
- 1840 — A Ms 7.4 earthquake strikes present-day Turkey and Armenia; combined with the effects of an eruption on Mount Ararat, kills 10,000 people.
- 1966 — France conducts its first nuclear weapon test in the Pacific, on Moruroa Atoll.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1644 — English Civil War: Battle of Marston Moor.
- 1890 — The U.S. Congress passes the Sherman Antitrust Act.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026	
4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
AUGUST 2026	
W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)